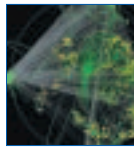


Internet, Redux

The Internet is a bunch of new technologies slapped on to old, which makes it too inefficient to last for long. The US National Science Foundation has commissioned scientists to “rethink” the Internet, and turn it faster, more efficient and more secure – into the Manhattan Project. But could this, too, blow up?



Microsoft Launches Online Store...

...but no one really cares. The company didn't make a big deal about its new Microsoft Store. After looking at it, we know why. Just your regular, run-of-the-mill online store here. However, instead of worrying about Vista DVDs, you can now download the OS once you've bought it.



Enter



Bruno Sargeant
Autodesk Sr Manager, TV and Broadcasting

Bruno Sargeant was recently in Mumbai. We caught up with him during his tour.

One of your recent acquisitions has been Mudbox. Why was that move necessary and was it to fend off any possible competition?

We're building a suite of tools for modeling and and Mudbox fits in well. It's a software perfect for users who aren't used to 3d modeling tools. The interface is simple and modeling in it is like playing with clay.

Has Autodesk considered entering the image editing space?

Autodesk's core-competency is 3D and post-processing. Image editing and 2D graphics applications in general is a market that has already well served so we do not see the need to go there

Is Autodesk being too aggressive by buying out possible competition? What do you think of free CG software like Blender or Wings3D?

Our products co-exist with all others. We've never shut down any software – we've only improved them. We are fine with free software in the market. For those who want to learn, we have a free Maya Learning Edition on our site.

What does the Indian television market mean for Autodesk?

India's television channel market is easily one of the fastest growing ones in the world. We already have a big client list of our products. High-definition television is something new and is definitely coming. Media houses have already started upgrading to the latest HD-ready Autodesk products.

THE PIRACY PROFIT PLAN

MTV Goes Gold-digging

The Great Copyright Infringement Lawsuit has become a symbol of fear, at least in the US. Organisations fear it – the last thing they want to do is to have to pay millions for the silliest indiscretion. Other organisations thrive on it – “Ah, so we made some crappy content. Let's see if we can sue someone and make up for our losses.” And the Little People – the Joe the Plumbers, as it were, must delete that collection of MP3s, or live with the fear that the RIAA will come a-knocking one day, and take them for every last penny, and some more.

Even with the so-called crackdown, piracy refuses to quit. Obviously, the content creators are fuming at the thought of all that money they aren't making. And then MTV had their “aha” moment – could it be that there is money to be made even from piracy?

Henceforth, when MySpace users post any content that infringes on MTV's copyrights, they won't demand that it be taken down. Instead, they'll slap an ad on it, and hopefully make some money there. This isn't a new idea, though – Google's been there too. If content owners find their copyrights being infringed on YouTube, they can choose to either pull that



content, or put an ad on it.

Yes, you hate ads. But would you rather be watching a real music video with ads, or an ad-free video of some idiot lip-syncing in front of a webcam (though they're not always mutually exclusive)? The bottom line is that if companies think they can make money off your desire to share with people, they might sit back and not bother you so much about your “crimes.” This means there will be more content for all and though we may be hoping for too much, may be they'll even encourage file-sharing.

TWICE AS NICE

Piracy 4 The People

It isn't just the content creators who are bothered about piracy – our poor ISPs, too, must deal with the strain we're putting on their networks. Bandwidth costs money, and ISPs in the US are now coming face to face with

the monster they created (“6 Mbps Unlimited for just \$33 (Rs 1,500)? What were we thinking?”). So Comcast, one of the nation's biggest ISPs, decided to introduce a term we love to hate – the download limit. Comcast subscribers will now be limited to downloading only 250 GB a month.

How horrifying.

Obviously, most people won't hit that limit – even at 6 Mbps – so it doesn't really matter. But that also means that piracy is still straining Comcast's networks. So instead of throttling P2P traffic like they originally planned, they've given P4P a try, and the results are amazing.

P4P – Proactive network Provider Participation for P2P – uses a technology called iTracker to find you as many peers on the ISP's network as possible. It's great for you, because if your ISP is using P4P, you will download at speeds that are around 80 per cent faster. And it's great for the ISP, because it doesn't increase their costs. Every time you download data from an international server (which you usually are), you're accessing your ISP's international link, and that access costs them money and hence costs you money. If you stick to downloading from servers that are in India, you're